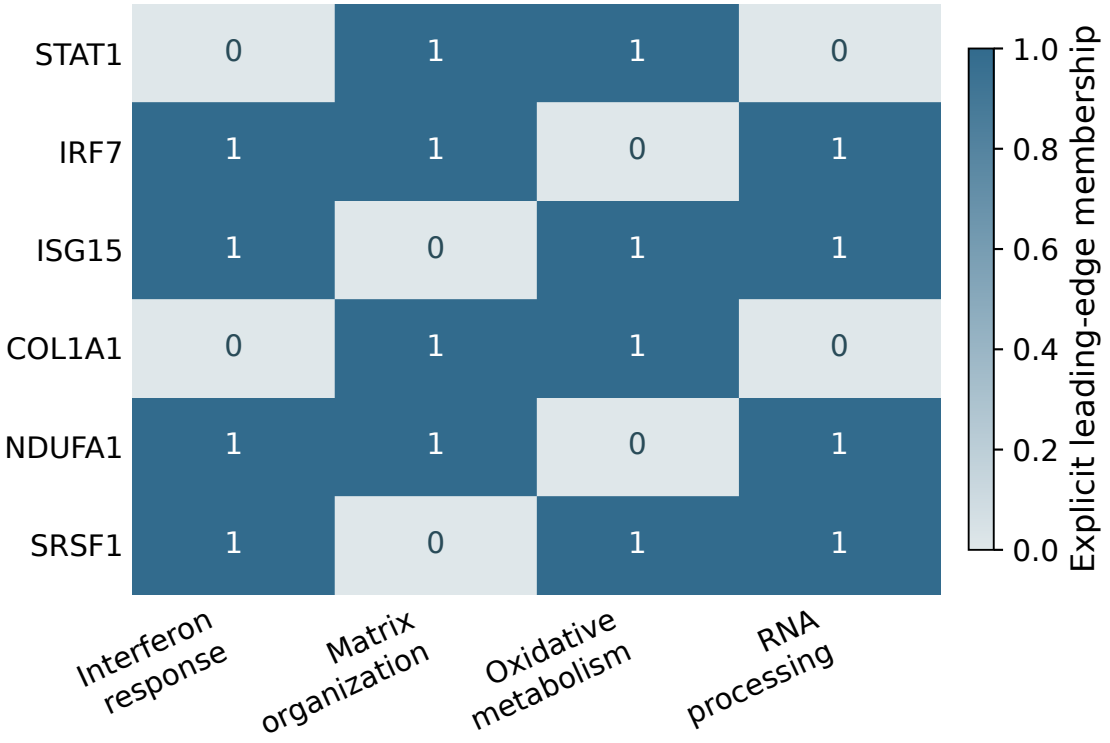Leading-edge support across the common gene scope